

CHAPTER

4

UNIT-II

Non Verbal Language

- "The most important thing in communication is hearing what isn't said."
— *Peter F. Drucker*
- "60% of all human communication is nonverbal body language; 30% is your tone, so that means 90% of what you're saying aren't coming out of your mouth."
— *Alex "Hitch" Hitchens*
- Non-verbal communication has a huge impact on a child's social well-being, yet development of this skill is often overlooked
— *Emory psychologist Steve Nowicki*
- Jerry, the throat-clear is a nonverbal indication of doubt. — *George, Seinfeld*
- Body language is a very powerful tool. We had body language before we had speech, and apparently, 80% of what you understand in a conversation is read through the body, not the words.
— *Deborah Bull*
- Get in touch with the way the other person feels. Feelings are 55% body language, 38% tone and 7% words.
— *Unknown*

4.1. SOME FACTS ABOUT NON VERBAL COMMUNICATION

Others assert that research has suggested that between 60 and 70 percent of all meaning is derived from nonverbal behavior.

1. Delve into the science of non-verbal signals as this very visual and highly entertaining expose reveals the hidden language in which 93% of human communication takes place.
2. From President Franklin D. Roosevelt, to British Prime Minister Winston Churchill and 2008 presidential hopefuls Senators Barack Obama and John McCain, see how both politicians and celebrities use the subtle movements of body language to persuade masses, establish power, and advance careers.

When we hear that oft-used word 'communication' — apart from stifling a yawn - we tend to equate it with just words. We forget about the 'silent language' of the face, the body - and the voice (how words are actually said). What we refer to as body language.

Think of those people you like, whether it be in your private or working life; also those people

in the public eye - celebrities, politicians, sports people and other prominent figures. Where does their like ability or 'charisma' come from? Is it just the words they say? It's probably the whole package of the way they communicate that distinguishes them from other people. Now think of people you're not particularly keen on. What is it about them that irritates you?

All of us - whether consciously or unconsciously - transmit a whole series of gestures, mannerisms and vocal cues that provide information relating to the state of our 'inner' world, at a particular moment in time. We enable others to 'read' our attitude, our mood and even status, in almost an instant. Almost in mirror fashion, this leads to - especially at the 'first impression' stage - the formation of another person's attitude towards you. Do they feel that they could get on with you? Do they like you? Could they envisage doing business with you? Are they misinterpreting some of your gestures or mannerisms (lack of eye contact for example) or vocal cues - for dishonesty?

I've learned that people may forget what you said, they may forget what you did, but they will never forget how you made them feel.

Case Study

Finally, India to get a successful political communicator as PM in Narendra Modi Prashant Jha, Hindustan Times, New Delhi Updated: May 21, 2014 07:35 IST



Modi bowed in respect at the steps of Parliament House as he arrived to attend a BJP parliamentary party meeting in New Delhi. (HT photo/Sonu Mehta)

When Narendra Modi spoke in the Central Hall of Parliament, he used a mix of oratory techniques that paid him rich dividends through the campaign. But the campaigner was now making a bid to rise above the acrimony that marked the poll season. He spoke according to the demands of time and space, respectful of institutions and

processes of democracy. He was deferential to party seniors and projected himself as a disciplined organisation man.

He was also playful, lacing his speech with humour and suspense. He picked a strand from an earlier speech by L.K. Advani, displaying quick thinking, to pass on a broader emotional message. Either deliberately or spontaneously, Modi also let go of his restrained, measured self and broke down. Narendra Modi a better salesman, communicator than me : Manmohan Singh

4.1.1. Non-Verbal Communication?

Verbal communication coexists alongside non-verbal communication, which can affect people's perceptions and exchanges in subtle but significant ways. Non-verbal communication includes body language, such as gestures, facial expressions, eye contact and posture. Touch is a non-verbal communication that not only indicates a person's feelings or level of comfort, but illustrates personality characteristics as well

"The most important thing in communication is hearing what isn't said."

— *Peter F. Drucker*

Nonverbal communication describes the process of shared cues between people, which goes hand-in-hand with public speaking. This can include eye contact, frequency of glances, blink rate, gestures, facial expressions, postures, and more.

Nonverbal signals can increase trust, clarity, and add interest to your presentation when yielded properly. Learning how to become more sensitive to body language and nonverbal cues will make you the best presenter you can be.

4.1.2. The Five Nonverbal Abilities

If you want to become a better communicator, it's important to become more sensitive not only to the body language and nonverbal cues of others, but also to your own.

Nonverbal communication cues can play five roles :

1. **Repetition** : they can repeat the message the person is making verbally.
2. **Contradiction** : they can contradict a message the individual is trying to convey.
3. **Substitution** : they can substitute for a verbal message. For example, a person's eyes can often convey a far more vivid message than words do.
4. **Complementing** : they may add to or complement a verbal message. A boss who pats a person on the back in addition to giving praise can increase the impact of the message.
5. **Accenting** : they may accent or underline a verbal message. Pounding the table, for example, can underline a message.

Strengthen Eye Contact

"A recent UK study found that participants found photos of people who are smiling and looking directly at you to be the most attractive, and the very same faces were found to be less attractive when looking away or off to the side."

— *Ph.D Carol Kinsey Goman*

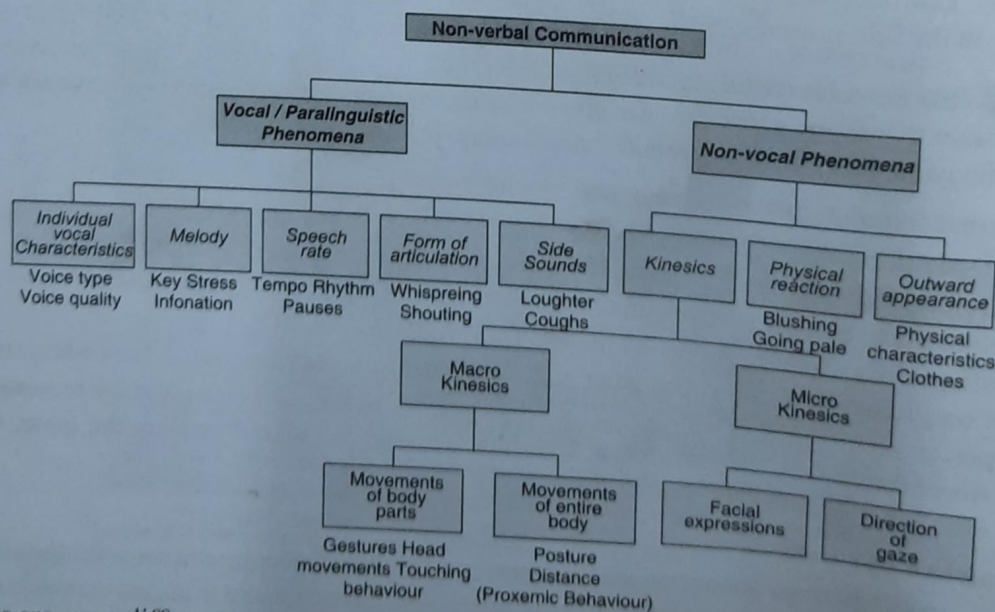
4.2. CHARACTERISTICS OF NONVERBAL COMMUNICATION

There are five characteristics of nonverbal communication and tell us why it is so important in our daily lives

1. Nonverbal communication is present in most interpersonal conversations, including cyberspace communication with the use of emoticons.
2. Nonverbal communication often conveys more information than verbal communication. It is possible that up to 93% of what we say is translated by nonverbal clues. However, it is more realistic that only 65-70% of translation is due to nonverbal communication.
3. Nonverbal communication is usually believed over verbal communication. This could be due to the fact that it is harder to hide or fake our nonverbal clues such as our facial expressions.
4. Nonverbal communication is the primary means of communicating emotion. Think of what someone's facial expressions look like when they are overjoyed or extremely sad. You can usually tell how they are feeling without them saying a word.
5. Nonverbal communication is meta communicative, for example, a wink for sarcasm or covering our mouth with our hand to indicate we are telling a secret.

4.3. TYPES OF NONVERBAL COMMUNICATION

6 Types of nonverbal communication



There are many different types of nonverbal communication. Together, the following nonverbal signals and cues communicate your interest and investment in others.

Facial expressions. The human face is extremely expressive, able to express countless emotions without saying a word. And unlike some forms of nonverbal communication, facial expressions are universal. The facial expressions for happiness, sadness, anger, surprise, fear, and disgust are the same across cultures.

Body movements and posture. Consider how your perceptions of people are affected by the way they sit, walk, stand up, or hold their head. The way you move and carry yourself communicates a wealth of information to the world. This type of nonverbal communication includes your posture, bearing, stance, and subtle movements.

Gestures. Gestures are woven into the fabric of our daily lives. We wave, point, beckon, and use our hands when we're arguing or speaking animatedly-expressing ourselves with gestures often without thinking. However, the meaning of gestures can be very different across cultures and regions, so it's important to be careful to avoid misinterpretation.

Eye contact. Since the visual sense is dominant for most people, eye contact is an especially important type of nonverbal communication. The way you look at someone can communicate many things, including interest, affection, hostility, or attraction. Eye contact is also important in maintaining the flow of conversation and for gauging the other person's response.

Touch. We communicate a great deal through touch. Think about the messages given by the following: a weak handshake, a timid tap on the shoulder, a warm bear hug, a reassuring slap on the back, a patronizing pat on the head, or a controlling grip on your arm.

Space. Have you ever felt uncomfortable during a conversation because the other person was standing too close and invading your space? We all have a need for physical space, although that need differs depending on the culture, the situation, and the closeness of the relationship. You can use physical space to communicate many different nonverbal messages, including signals of intimacy and affection, aggression or dominance.

Voice. It's not just what you say, it's how you say it. When we speak, other people "read" our voices in addition to listening to our words. Things they pay attention to include your timing and pace, how loud you speak, your tone and inflection, and sounds that convey understanding, such as "ahh" and "uh-huh." Think about how someone's tone of voice, for example, can indicate sarcasm, anger, affection, or confidence.

4.4. PARALANGUAGE (VOICE, TONE, VOLUME, SPEED, PITCH, EFFECTIVE PAUSE),

The Voice is a very important part of the nonverbal communication. Each time we speak, our voice tells the others' something about us: gender, emotional state, our relationship with the person we are talking to, age, background, origin, level of education and so on. These data are included in small fragments of speech, that can be read remarkably accurate. We encode information about ourselves when we speak, the others decode this information (as well as they can).

Beware of persons whose bellies do not move when they laugh.

— Chinese Proverb

4-6

The messages that we send with our voice are known as paralanguage. Often it is not what we say but how we say it that determines an interaction's outcome. Our vocal paralanguage is composed of all cues different from the words we use: *pronunciation, accent, fluency, emotion, charisma, sarcasm, contempt, deference, truth or deception* etc.

Vocal paralanguage is extremely subtle, but the clues in our voices are clear and legible. This makes vocal paralanguage one of the most powerful 'channels' of nonverbal communication.

Tone. The expression "O.K." convey different meanings depending on whether it is spoken sincerely or sarcastically, and our interpretation influences how we respond to the person who said it. The tone of our voice can help us communicate what we mean or it can reveal thoughts we intend to conceal. The sound of our voice is revealing to others our emotional state, attitudes, personality, status, and interaction maintenance, or turn-taking, needs. How we speak influences how others interpret our intentions, as well as how credible, intelligent, or attractive they judge us to be.

The paralanguage's characteristics are: pitch, volume, rate, articulation, pronunciation, hesitations, and silence. Each plays an important role in the impressions others form of us.

Pitch. Pitch is the highness or lowness of the voice. It is controlled by our breath and the tension of the vocal cords as they open and close to create sound. This tension restricts the airflow and creates vibration. Higher pitches are associated with female voices and lower pitches with male voices.

Volume. Generally speaking, listeners prefer a loud voice to a soft one. However, both can be useful. A loud voice is authoritative and attention getting, but at the same time, can be perceived as aggressive. A soft voice can reflect calm self-assurance, but also timidity. Either, however, can become a distraction if used excessively or with the wrong intent. Our volume should reflect the nature of our message and the size.

Speed. Listeners prefer a slightly faster pace to a slower pace. However, rapid speech can signal impatience, nervousness and insecurity. Slower speech, on the other hand, is useful for making an important point. Speakers who vary their pace and use pauses keep their listeners more engaged.

Most of us speak at an average rate of 150 words per minute. When we exceed 275 to 300 words per minute, it is difficult for others to comprehend what we are saying. In contrast, if we speak too slowly, others may perceive us as timid or lacking intelligence.

Articulation and Pronunciation. The sound attributes of articulation and pronunciation affect message intelligibility as well as perceptions of credibility. Articulation is the way we pronounce individual sounds. Ideally, the sounds of our speech are sharp and distinct. When we fail to utter a final sound (a final t or d, for example), fail to produce the sounds of words properly, or voice a sound in an unclear, imprecise way (come wimme versus come with me, dem versus them, idear versus idea), perceptions of our credibility drop. When we mispronounce a word, we may suffer a loss of credibility, and those listening to us may find it more difficult to make sense of what we are saying. Mumbling often indicates a lack of confidence. A speaker who mumbles

chronically should practice enunciation every day and in combination with effective volume, pace, and tone.

Pause. Knowing when to pause is a critical skill. When nervous or tense, we may exhibit a tendency to fill all pauses, often by inserting meaningless sounds or phrases such as uh, you know, or okay in the effort to fill voids. These phenomena disrupt the natural flow of speech and adversely affect how others perceive our competence and confidence. In addition to slowing the rate of speech and emphasizing key ideas, brief periods of silence or pauses give us a chance to gather our thoughts. Sustained pauses allow us to give another the "silent treatment," a means by which we ignore a person, saying to him or her without using words, "I don't care about you, you don't exist for me." We also tend to become silent during moments of extreme anxiety or annoyance..

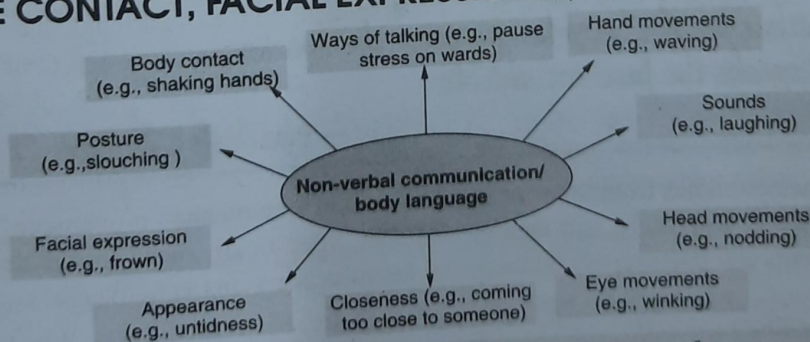
Intonation. Intonation is the way that the sender's pitch of voice rises and falls when speaking. For example, it shows the interpreter whether the speaker expresses his or her message in the form of a question or statement. In the first case, the voice rises at the end of the phrase or the sentence and in the second case, it falls. At the same time, intonation indicates the end of an entity of information, which – in written communication – is shown by means of a comma, semicolon, point, exclamation mark or question mark. Another function of intonation is to lay emphasis on a particular word or idea, a detail that the interpreter must not fail to be aware of.

Activity

How to be aware of the sound of your voice.

Record your voice on a recording device, play it back, and look for patterns or extremes. When speaking, examine your voice along with your body language to see how they match up.

4.5. BODY LANGUAGE (POSTURE, GESTURE, EYE CONTACT, FACIAL EXPRESSIONS), KINESICS



Each of us knows how to use our body parts to send messages but not many of us realize that people in different parts of the world 'speak' different body languages. A signal for 'yes' in one culture may mean 'no' in another; a gesture for 'good-bye' in one culture can be interpreted as 'come here' in another.

4-8

Business people and politicians have long recognized the importance of body language or non-verbal communication; many receive training in nonverbal communication before serving overseas. Since 9/11, airport and transit police have been trained on body language recognition. But training in body language is still relatively new for educators even though most American campuses include faces from different parts of the globe. It is therefore important that educators understand not only how to receive messages through body language but also what messages they may be sending even when they are not talking. Misunderstanding of body language may not only cause a long-lasting embarrassment but also be a life threat.

Non verbal communication. It is also can be classified in different types as following :

1. Kinesics – the study of movements
2. Haptics – the study of touch
3. Proxemics – the study of space
4. Chronemics – the study of time
5. Appearance – the study of dress
6. Iconics – the study of objects
7. Paraliguistic – complimentary meaning.
8. Vocalics – the study of non-verbal communicative aspects of the voice
9. Oculistics – the study of eye movement
10. Offactics – the study of scent

Kinesics

*If you want to find the truth,
do no listen to the words coming to you.
Rather see the body language of the speaker.
It speaks the fact not audible*

– Bhavesh Chatbar

The word kinesics comes from the root word kinesis, which means “movement,” and refers to the study of hand, arm, body, and face movements. Specifically, here are the use of gestures, head movements and posture, eye contact, and facial expressions as nonverbal communication.

4.5.1. Definition

‘Body language,’ includes all the communication through the non-verbal channel. This can include how we greet others, how we sit or stand, our facial expressions, our clothes, hair styles, tone of voice, eye movements, how we listen, how we breathe, how close we stand to others, and how we touch others. The pressure of body language can especially be felt in emotional

situations where body language usually prevails over words. This article will use the terms 'body language' and 'nonverbal communication interchangeably.

4.5.2. The Importance of Body Language

Edward T. Hall (1959), a well-recognized social anthropologist, maintained that in a normal conversation more than 65 percent of social meanings are transmitted through the non-verbal channel. People in other parts of the world, especially Asians, are more perceptive to body language than the North Americans.

Misuse of body language can be an unpleasant or even dangerous experience for message encoders. Consider the following examples:

4.5.3. Understanding Body Language from Head to Toes

According to Argyle (1978), humans have more than 700,000 forms of body language. This article will give a few examples of how body parts, from head to toes, are used for communicating in different parts of the world. Interested persons can read further from the references given at the end of this article.

Head. In most societies, a nodding head signifies agreement or approval. But in some cultures, like parts of Greece, Yugoslavia, Bulgaria and Turkey, a nodding head means 'no.' In most Asian cultures, head is where spirit resides and one should not touch another's head.

Face. Facial expressions reflect emotions, feelings, and attitudes. While expressing 'true' feeling and emotion is valued in the West, it is prohibited in the East. The Asians, who are taught to practice self-control, are often labeled as 'emotionless' and of possessing 'mixed-up emotions.' Smiling in the East is not necessarily a sign of happiness; rather it signifies 'yes,' 'I don't understand what you said,' or can be a cover-up for embarrassment.

Eyes. While good eye contact is praised and expected in the West, it is seen as a sign of disrespect and challenge in other cultures, including Asian and African. The less eye contact these groups have with an individual, the more respect they show.

Closing eyes. In 1975, former Vice President Walter Mondale was invited to speak to the Japanese Diet. He became irritated when he noticed that more than half of the audience closed their eyes. When the talk was over, Mondale snapped at the U.S. ambassador, 'Why did I bother to come and talk to them?' 'Why, Sir?' the ambassador asked. 'They didn't care to hear what I had to say ; they were sleeping.' 'No, Sir,' the ambassador replied, 'they closed their eyes to close out everything else in order to digest your speech.'

Nose. Tapping the nose is more common in Europe than in the United States. It means 'confidential' in England but 'watch out!' in Italy. Blowing the nose on public streets, while seen as an impolite gesture in North America, is a common practice in most Asian countries. This rids the body of waste and; therefore, it is seen as healthy. At the same time the Asians do not understand why the Americans blow their noses onto a Kleenex that is put back in their pocket and carried with them throughout the day.

4-10

Lips and Mouth. Kissing is a sign of love or affection in the West. People kiss when they meet or when they say goodbye. But kissing is viewed as an intimate act in Asia and is not permissible in public. In some cultures, such as Filipino, Native American, Puerto Rican, and several Latin American, people use their lips to point, instead of a finger.

Arms. Some cultures, like the Italians, use their arms freely. Others, like the Japanese, are more reserved; in Japan it is considered impolite to gesture with broad movements of the arms.

Hands. Of all the body parts, the hands probably are used most for communicating non-verbally. Hand waves are used for greeting, beckoning, or farewell. The American 'goodbye' wave can be interpreted in many parts of Europe and Latin America as the signal for 'no.' The Italian 'goodbye' wave can be interpreted by Americans as the gesture of 'come here.' The American 'come here' gesture can be seen as an insult in most Asian countries where they use it for calling an animal. Asians call others with a similar hand movement but with their palm downward.

Legs and Feet. Sitting cross-legged is common in North America and some European countries but it is viewed as disrespectful in Asia and the Middle East where a solid and balanced sitting posture is the prevailing custom. In Asia and the Middle East, resting the ankle over the other knee risks pointing the sole of your shoe at another person, which is considered a very rude gesture. One should never point or move an object with their feet in these cultures.

Conclusion. Becoming sensitive to the clues of body language can help us communicate more effectively with students or scholars from other cultures. We can understand what they are saying even when they are not talking. We can sense when students are silent and digesting information, or when they are silent and confused. We can share feelings too strong or too difficult to be expressed in words, or decode a secret message that passes silently from person to person. Body language can help us spot contradictions between what students say and what they really mean. Finally, we can learn to be more sensitive to our own bodies, to see what messages they are sending and to see ourselves as others see us. We are our bodies.

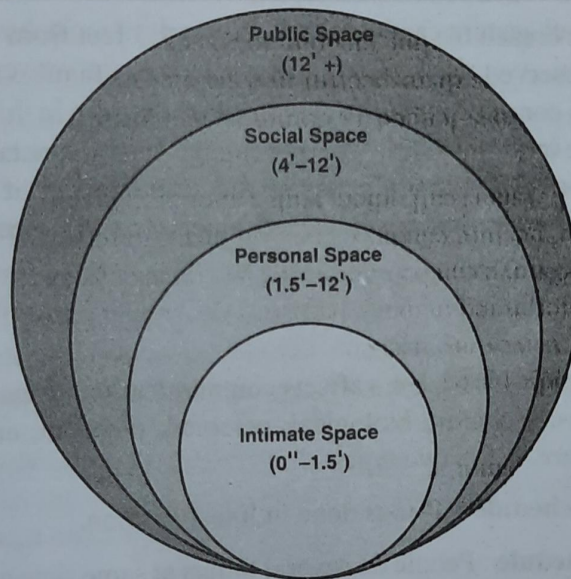
4.6. PROXEMICS

Proxemics refers to the study of how space and distance influence communication. We only need look at the ways in which space shows up in common metaphors to see that space, communication, and relationships are closely related. For example, when we are content with someone, we say we are "close" to him or her. When we lose connection with someone, we may say he or she is "distant." In general, space influences how people communicate and behave. Smaller spaces with a higher density of people often lead to breaches of our personal space bubbles. If this is a setting in which this type of density is expected beforehand, like at a crowded concert or on a train during rush hour, then we make various communicative adjustments to manage the space issue. Unexpected breaches of personal space can lead to negative reactions, especially if we feel someone has violated our space voluntarily, meaning that a crowding situation didn't force them into our space). To better understand how proxemics functions in nonverbal communication, we will more closely examine the proxemic distances associated with personal space and the concept of territoriality.

4.6.1. Proxemic Distances

We all have varying definitions of what our “*personal space*” is, and these definitions are contextual and depend on the situation and the relationship. Scholars have identified four zones for US Americans, which are public, social, personal, and intimate distance. Edward T. Hall, “*Proxemics*,” *Current Anthropology* 9, no. 2 (1968): 83-95. The zones are more elliptical than circular, taking up more space in our front, where our line of sight is, than at our side or back where we can't monitor what people are doing. You can see how these zones relate to each other and to the individual in “*Proxemic Zones of Personal Space*”. Even within a particular zone, interactions may differ depending on whether someone is in the outer or inner part of the zone.

4.6.2. Proxemic Zones of Personal Space



1. Public Space (12 Feet or More). Public and social zones refer to the space four or more feet away from our body, and the communication that typically occurs in these zones is formal and not intimate. Public space starts about twelve feet from a person and extends out from there. It would be difficult to have a deep conversation with someone at this level because you have to speak louder and don't have the physical closeness that is often needed to promote emotional closeness and/or establish rapport.

2. Social Space (4-12 Feet). Communication that occurs in the social zone, which is four to twelve feet away from our body, is typically in the context of a professional or casual interaction, but not intimate or public. This distance is preferred in many professional settings because it reduces the suspicion of any impropriety. The expression “keep someone at an arm's length” means that someone is kept out of the personal space and kept in the social/professional space. When students have more personal information to discuss, they will come closer, which brings them into the inner part of the social zone.

3. Personal Space (1.5-4 Feet). Personal and intimate zones refer to the space that starts at our physical body and extends four feet. These zones are reserved for friends, close acquaintances,

and significant others. Much of our communication occurs in the personal zone, which is what we typically think of as our “*personal space bubble*” and extends from 1.5 feet to 4 feet away from our body. Even though we are getting closer to the physical body of another person, we may use verbal communication at this point to signal that our presence in this zone is friendly and not intimate. This zone allows for relatively intimate communication but doesn’t convey the intimacy that a closer distance would, which can be beneficial in professional settings. The inner-personal zone extends from 1.5 feet to 2.5 feet and is a space reserved for communication with people we are interpersonally close to or trying to get to know. In this subzone, we can easily touch the other person as we talk to them, briefly placing a hand on his or her arm or engaging in other light social touching that facilitates conversation, self-disclosure, and feelings of closeness.

4. Intimate Space. As we breach the invisible line that is 1.5 feet from our body, we enter the intimate zone, which is reserved for only the closest friends, family, and romantic/intimate partners. It is impossible to completely ignore people when they are in this space, even if we are trying to pretend that we’re ignoring them. We need regular human contact that isn’t just verbal but also physical. We have already discussed the importance of touch in nonverbal communication, and in order for that much-needed touch to occur, people have to enter our intimate space.

4.7. CHRONEMICS

Chronemics refers to the study of how time affects communication. Time can be classified into several different categories, including biological, personal, physical, and cultural time. The way time is used in a culture. It has two types

1. **Monochronic time schedule :** Things done in linear fashion.
2. **Polychronic time schedule :** People do several things at same time and place higher value on personal involvement than on getting things done on time.

Iconics Communication. Iconics is the use of physical objects or office designs to communicate status or culture, such as :

1. display of trophies
2. diplomas
3. pictures of important people

Haptics. It is a study of touch as non verbal communication. It includes

1. Handshake
2. A pat on shoulder
3. Shaking hands
4. Holding hands
5. Put on the back.

4.8. APPEARANCE

1. Personal appearance
2. Physical Appearance

4.8.1. Personal Appearance

Personal appearance is an often disregarded part of communication and presentation skills.

When you are speaking in public you may be representing your organisation or just yourself, but it is still you in the front line. It is you that the other person, group or audience sees and before you have time to open your mouth and give an account of yourself, certain assumptions, both consciously and subconsciously, have been made.

First impressions are very important - they can be about attitude as well as dress.

Visual impact is at least as important as verbal impact, people will very quickly make assumptions based on your facial expressions, the clothes you wear, how well groomed you are and your body language.

4.8.2. Physical Appearance

Our choice of color, clothing, hairstyles, and other factors affecting appearance are also considered a means of nonverbal communication. According to what people see when they first set their eyes on you, judgments about your personality and abilities are going to be concluded.

“Quality is more important than quantity” This really applies here as well.

It is really pivotal to dress up properly for any business or job offer we may encounter. One shouldn't focus on wearing too many accessories, jewellery and make up. What is very vital is the physical appearance and the proper hairstyle.

Appearances also include:

1. Body cleanliness
2. Clean Nails
3. Shiny shoes
4. No tattoos

Being appropriately dressed. You've heard the expression, “Clothes make the man (or woman).” That may be a slight exaggeration, since there are other determining factors, but in a large degree, it is true. What you wear in this world can make you or break you in many situations. Your clothes can be your best friend or your worst enemy.

Your dress conveys nonverbal clues about your personality, education, background, financial status and credibility. These clues can break down barriers and launch careers, or create barriers and hamper careers.

4-14

At times, clothes are the only visible clues to our personalities. Even when other indicators are more apparent; clothing continues to make a statement. Our mode of dress may also reveal anger, aggressiveness, uncertainty or depression.

Your knowledge of nonverbal clothing clues will be useful not only in gaining some initial understanding of people, but also in interacting with them on a daily basis. Even small changes in the way an associate looks from day to day can signal other changes that may be important to you. Certainly, your skill at interpreting the visual code of dress can enhance your ability to relate to others. As you learn to interpret even more subtle messages from others, remember that you are transmitting equally revealing messages yourself. For better or worse, realize that your outward appearance and demeanor influence how others will react to you. By emphasizing the positive aspects of yourself through your dress and grooming, you can inspire confidence in your abilities and judgment, as well as lift your self-esteem. In essence, your clothing can be a self-fulfilling self-portrait

4.9. ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES OF NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION

Advantages or functions or importance of non-verbal communication. There is a proverb "Actions speak louder than words." In essence, this underscores the importance of non-verbal communication. Non-verbal communication is especially significant in intercultural situations. Researches in communication suggest that many more feelings and intentions are sent and received non-verbally than verbally. Mehrabian and Wiener following suggested that only 7 % of message is sent through words, with remaining 93% sent non-verbal expressions (depending on author, verbal part goes up to 35%). It has multiple advantages or functions :

1. **Complementary.** Non-verbal cues complement a verbal message by adding to its meaning. You can pat someone you offended at the back as you say sorry to him or her.
2. **Easy presentation.** Information can be easily presented in non-verbal communication through using visual, audio-visual and silent means of non-verbal communication.
3. **Substituting.** Non-verbal message may substitute for the verbal message especially if it is blocked by noise, interruption, long distance etc. for example: gestures-finger to lips to indicate need for quite, facial expressions- a nod instead of a yes.
4. **Accenting.** Often used to accent a verbal message. Verbal tone indicates the actual meaning of the specific words.
5. **Repeat.** Used to repeat the verbal message (e.g. point in a direction while stating directions.)
6. **Help to illiterate people.** This type of communication use gestures, facial expressions, eye contact, proximity, touching etc. and without using any spoken or written word. So, it is very much helpful for illiterate people.
7. **Help to handicapped people.** Non-verbal cues of communication greatly help in handicapped people especially to deaf people. Deaf people are exchange message through the movements of hands, fingers, eye ball etc.

8. **Attractive presentation.** Non-verbal communication is based on visual, picture, graph, sign etc. that can be seen very much attractive.
9. **Reducing wastage of time.** The message of non-verbal communication reached the receiver very fast. For this reason it reduces the wastage of valuable time of the communicator.
10. **Quick expression of message.** Non-verbal cues of communication like sign and symbol can also communicate some messages very quickly than written or oral messages.

Disadvantages or limitations of non-verbal communication. Despite of advantages of non-verbal communication, it is not free from its limitations or disadvantages which are:

1. **Vague and imprecise.** Non-verbal communication is quite vague and imprecise. Since in this communication there is no use of words or language which expresses clear meaning to the receiver. No dictionary can accurately classify them. Their meaning varies not only by culture and context but by degree of intention.
2. **Continuous.** It is possible to stop talking in verbal communication, but it is generally not possible to stop nonverbal cues. Also, spoken language has a structure that makes it easier to tell when a subject has changed, for instance or to analyze its grammar. Nonverbal does not lend itself to this kind of analysis.
3. **Multi-channel.** While watching someone's eyes, you may miss something significant in a hand gesture. Everything is happening at once and therefore it may be confusing to try to keep up with everything. Most of us simply do not do so, at least not consciously.
4. **Culture-bound.** Non-verbal communication is learnt in childhood, passed on to you by your parents and others with whom you associate. A few other gestures seem to be universal. Evidence suggests that humans of all cultures smile when happy and frown when unhappy. However, most nonverbal symbols seem to be even further disconnected from any "essential meaning" than verbal symbols.
5. **Long conversations are not possible.** In non-verbal communication, long conversation and necessary explanations are not possible. No party can discuss the particular issues of the messages.
6. **Difficult to understand.** Difficult to understand and requires a lot of repetitions in non-verbal communication. Since it uses gestures, facial expressions eye contact, touch etc. for communicating with others which may not be understandable for the simple and foolish people.
7. **Not everybody prefers.** Everybody not prefers to communicate through non-verbal communication with others. Sometimes it cannot create an impression upon people or listeners. It is less influential and cannot be used everywhere. It is cannot be used as a public tool for communication.

4-16

8. **Lack of formality.** Non-verbal communication does not follow any rules, formality or structure like other communication. Most of the cases people unconsciously and habitually engaged in non-verbal communication by moving the various parts of the body.
9. **Costly.** In some cases non-verbal communication involves huge cost. For example, neon sign, power point presentation, cinema etc. are very much costly compared to others form of communication.
10. **Distortion of information.** Since it uses gestures, facial expressions, eye contact, touch, sign, sound, paralanguage etc. for communicating with others, there is a great possibility in distortion of information in non-verbal communication.

4.10. TRANSLATE EMOTIONS INTO WRITTEN BODY LANGUAGE

Emotion	Possible Body Language
Anticipation	rub hands together, lick lips, unable to sit still, grin slack-jawed, unable to move, fixed gaze
Amusement	throw head back, slap thighs, clap hands, shake with laughter
Anger or Aggression	shake fist, point finger, stab finger, slam fist on a table, flushed face, throbbing veins in neck, jutting chin, clench fists, drench jaw, lower eyebrows, squint eyes, bare teeth, a wide stance, tight-lipped smile
Annoyance	press lips together, narrow eyes, roll eyes, exasperated sighs
Anxiety	fidget, twist a ring, chew on a pencil, bite lip, swallow constantly, quickened breathing, hold breath, darting eyes, sweat, clammy palms, high-pitched laughter, hunched posture, pace, stutter, play with hair
Attentiveness	furrowed brow, lean forward, sit up, take notes, mimic body language
Confidence	yawn, avoid eye contact, tap feet, twirl a pen, doodle, fidget, slouch clasp arms behind body, lift head, push chest out, stand tall, make firm and precise movements
Confusion	tilt head, narrow eyes, furrowed brow, shrug
Contempt	lift chin, purse lips, sneer, stretch or turn away, dismissive hand-waving
Cynical	twist lips, half-smile, shake head, press lips with a slight frown, toll eyes
Deception	one sided shoulder shrug, look down, scratch nose/ear/neck, feet kick out or shuffle involuntarily, sudden change in demeanour, hesitation in speech, shifty eye contact, long blinks, shrug, unwarranted smiles or laughter, shake head 'no' while saying 'yes', lick lips, cover/touch mouth

Emotion	Possible Body Language
Defensive	cross arms or legs, arms out with palms forward, hands up, place anything in front of body, hands in pockets
Desire	flirtatious behaviour, wink, look up through the lashes, glance over the shoulder, make eye contact, touch hair or clothing, straighten spine, strike a 'cowboy' pose with thumbs in belt, dilated pupils, arch, stretch, women cross and uncross legs
Disbelief	wide-eyed (shock), narrow-eyed (sceptical), twist mouth, crinkle nose, crease brow
Disgust	crinkle nose, curled lip, flinch, turn away, cover nose, gag, squint eyes shut, protect body by turning shoulder (cold shoulder)
Displeasure	fake smile, pout, frown, cross arms
Distress	Stroke/rub nape of neck, wide eyes, shallow rapid breathing, beat walls, huddle in a corner, clasp hands over head, rock, wring hands, run hands through hair, adjust cuffs, men hold hands together in front of crotch
Embarrassment	blush, stammer, cover face with hands, bow head, trouble maintaining eye contact, look down and away, blink back tears
Fatigue	rub eyes, stare into space, yawn and/or stretch, nod off and jerk awake, grit teeth, close eyes, move slowly, slouch
Fear	hunch shoulders, shrink back, mouth open, widen eyes, shake, tremble, freeze, rock from side to side, wrap arms around self, shaking hands
Frustration	shake head, massage temples, clasp wrist in opposite hand or behind back, aggressively run hands through hair, show white knuckles

EXERCISE

1. Explain features of kinesics in non-verbal communication.
2. What role does body language play in making oral presentation attractive and effective?
3. Write a short note on Proxemics and chronemics.
4. Discuss the nuances of voices dynamics and explain the four modes of speech delivery in a presentation.
5. Define non verbal communication.
6. Compare and contrast verbal communication and non verbal communication.
7. Provide examples of the functions of non verbal communication.

8. When someone sends you a mixed message in which the verbal and nonverbal messages contradict each other, which one do you place more meaning on? Why?
9. What are the various media of expression? Explain.
10. Getting integrated to better understand non verbal communication, try to think of an example to illustrate each of the four principles discussed in the chapter. Be integrative in your approach by including at least one example from an academic, professional, civic and personal context.
11. Gestures make communication more effective.
12. Do you agree with the statement that 'Silence is also sometimes a good means of communication'?
13. What is the relevance of eye contact in the process of communication?
14. Suggest any four ways in which an individual can communicate non-verbally.

○○○